

were good enough and that I wouldn't know for sure unless I tried. Turns out he was right.

Today we want to give you permission.

We don't know what your situation is, but we hope we showed you in this book how adaptable improving your spending habits can be. That wherever you are, you can do something, and you can start today. You don't have to start with waking up at 5 a.m. or getting a stationary bike! Maybe your next step is just getting curious about what you truly value. Maybe it's reevaluating what you thought you valued, or maybe it's finally time to pull the trigger on selling a car or something else with a payment that's too high. The great thing is that you don't have to follow every suggestion in this book to be successful.

As you find permission to make the changes and do the out of the ordinary with your spending, you also help others find their own permission. Changing the way you spend gives the opportunity to impact hundreds of lives: your family, friends, coworkers, strangers on the internet, and people across the globe who you will never meet. No influencer status needed.

Permission Givers

It has long been said that consumption drives the economy. The foundation of modern macroeconomics tells us that demand drives supply, that healthy economies spend or invest more than they save, and that governments should always seek to increase spending, even if it means going into debt. For the last one hundred years, it has been our civic duty to consume. And consume we have.

In 2023, the average American made \$150 worth of impulse purchases every month. The year prior, before rampant inflation settled in, that amount was over \$300 on impulse purchases every month. So, when inflation cools and your lifestyle inflates, what if your impulse spending didn't? What if it stayed at \$150 per month instead of inflating back to \$300? That's \$150 per month, \$1,800 per year that you can put toward things you really love. After five years, you'll have preserved \$9,000. And along the way, if you gave permission to five friends who saved a cumulative \$45,000, and they each gave permission to five more friends